UNIT 1: BEGINNING YOUR JOURNEY, CAREER READINESS ORIENTATION

TOPIC 7: EXPLORING CAREERS

Topic OBJECTIVES: The learner will:

- Discover how their interests, skills, personality and values can help them explore careers that might be a good match for them
- Understand that there are numerous jobs in one career cluster

Topic OUTCOMES: The learner will:

- Complete assessments that will help identify possible career paths
- Create a portfolio on Mass CIS
- Identify careers of interest and how to find out more about those careers

Topic ACTIVITIES:

I. Welcome to the Day

Opening Questions:

- When you were a kid, what did you dream about 'being' when you grew up?
- If you could have any job in the world, what would you want to do?

Opening Quotes:

- "The best careers advice to give to the young is 'Find out what you like doing best and get someone to pay you for doing it.' "
  ~ *Katherine Whitehorn* (journalist, writer, and columnist)
- "What is the recipe for successful achievement? To my mind there are just four essential ingredients: Choose a career you love, give it the best there is in you, seize your opportunities, and be a member of the team."
  ~ *Benjamin F. Fairless*
- "If you wish to achieve worthwhile things in your personal and career life, you must become a worthwhile person in your own self-development."
  ~ *Brian Tracy* (self-help author)

Real-World Application Check-in:

- Ask participants to share observations and thoughts.

II. Activity

Part One: Create a Career/Job List

This is a fun Challenge that can be done in a number of different ways

- Relay Race — hang flipchart paper up and have the teams line up behind a designated spot on the floor. When you say go, have one person from the team run to the flipchart and write down a career/job they know. When they are finished, they run back, give the marker to the next person on their team, etc.
  - The relay race can be to see who can come up with the most jobs in 5 minutes (or amount of time you designate).
  - You can put the numbers 1-25 (or any number) on the flip chart, with lines after each number to write jobs on and see which team can come up with 25 jobs first.
  - You can put the letters A-Z on flipchart, with a line after each letter to write jobs on and see which team can come up with one job for each letter first.
- You can do the same thing, but instead of making it a relay race, just have teams sit together at one table to complete the challenge (the most in a designated time, the first to write a certain number or the first to write something for every letter).
- You could also do this as an individual challenge.

After the challenge, compile all of the team's lists to create one giant job list.

Part Two: Who do you know?

- Have individuals, small groups, large group identify people they know in the jobs on the compiled list.
- Have individuals think about other people they know and what they do — and try to add to the large list.

Part Three: Expanding Career Options — Everyday Things (directions included)

III. Mass CIS

- Sign in and create your portfolio.
- Complete Assessments, save results in your Mass CIS portfolio, and print the results for your folder/binder.
  - Career Cluster Inventory
  - O*Net Interest Profiler
  - Work Importance Locator
  - Occupation Sort

IV. Explore Possible Careers

Choose one career area that you are interested in that might be a good fit for you based on today's assessments as well as previous assessments (personality, multiple intelligences, values, skills). Using Mass CIS or other career exploration websites (www.careervoyages.gov or http://www.bls.gov/oco/home.htm or http://online.onetcenter.org/), research the career area of interest and complete the career information web.

If there is time, have participants share what they have learned about the career area they researched. If some people finish before others, they can explore and research another career area of interest.

Real-World Application: Talk to a variety of people that you know. Talk to them about the career area you researched and ask them if they know anyone who works in that career area. Keep track of how many people your 'network' could connect you to in this career area.

Everyday Things

Have you ever wondered how jobs come about? Jobs are created to solve problems—to provide a product or service that someone needs or wants. Sometimes people don't even know that there is a want, need or market for the service or product.

For example, do you know who Steve Jobs is? In 1973, in his garage, with a friend, Steve Jobs developed the personal computer that later became the Apple II. Now he is CEO of Apple, a leader in personal computers, which he co-founded in 1976, and Pixar, the Academy-Award-winning animation studios that he co-founded in 1986. Pixar has created four of the most successful and beloved animated films of all time: *Toy Story* (1995), *A Bug's Life* (1998), *Toy Story 2* (1999) and *Monsters Inc.* (2001). Pixar's four films have together earned more than $1.5 billion box office receipts worldwide. Pixar's next films, *Finding Nemo* and *Pirates of the Caribbean* were released in the summer of 2003.

Big businesses and the government used computers. The computers were so big that they filled small rooms. However, Steve Jobs and others had the idea that every person needed a computer — a personal computer so small it would fit on a "desktop." Every person would need his own computer as a part of his daily life. This was a revolutionary idea. At the same time, scientists at Texas Instruments and Bell Labs were advancing silicon chip technology. Voila! Personal computers. What other products and services have come from the computer explosion that started in the 1970's?

In this activity, you'll think about common objects to consider all the different kinds of jobs necessary to produce and deliver them. For example, how did construction work come about? Human beings need shelter, so people have jobs designing, building, advertising, selling, decorating and repairing homes.

Below are several everyday things. Think of as many career ideas as possible for each object. Be creative! For example, watermelon might elicit the following ideas: farmer, trucker, grocery clerk, food broker, chef, creator of a web site with recipes, creator of a web site that sells food.

Everyday object: chair
Career ideas:

Everyday object: house
Career ideas:

Everyday object: DVD Player
Career ideas:

Everyday object: aspirin
Career ideas:

Everyday object: telephone
Career ideas:

Everyday object: car
Career ideas:

Everyday object: computer
Career ideas:

List here types of jobs you'd like to find out about:

From Empower Your Future, Part I